Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Tuesday, 27 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light rain	Heavy drizzle	Light drizzle	Rain
17° 10°	16° 8°	16° 9°	16° 7°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **An independent review has been announced into the murder of student Henry Nowak, with the Home Secretary vowing to get to the truth.**

The Home Secretary stated that a thorough investigation is needed to understand all the events leading up to, during, and after that tragic night. This comes after the student's murder sparked widespread concern.

CRIME · UK

2 **Storm Boelo has left thousands of homes without power across the UK, as the Met Office issues a new wind warning for tonight.**

Around 22,000 properties are still affected after the storm swept through, with a fresh warning for strong winds covering parts of England, Wales, Scotland, and Northern Ireland from 6pm.

WEATHER · UK

3 **Two drivers have been jailed after killing a mother and her young daughter while racing on a public road in Leeds.**

Justyna Hulboj and her daughter Lena tragically died in January 2023 when they were hit by one of the cars. The court heard the drivers were engaged in a dangerous race.

CRIME · UK

4 **Number 10 appears to be backtracking on the Prime Minister's recent suggestion of a referendum on freedom of movement.**

The Prime Minister had spoken about starting a 'conversation' regarding future options for the UK's relationship with the EU. However, Downing Street now seems to be playing down the prospect of a vote.

POLITICS · UK

5 **Consultant doctors in England are set to stage a 48-hour walkout next month in an ongoing dispute over pay and pensions.**

The senior doctors will begin their strike on November 25th, which is likely to cause significant disruption to NHS services. Negotiations with the government have so far failed to resolve the dispute.

HEALTH · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Excitement is building for the release of the new 'ACOTAR' book, with fans planning gatherings to celebrate the latest instalment.**

Dozens of fans are expected to meet at Wolverhampton Arts Centre to mark the arrival of the highly anticipated new title. The 'A Court of Thorns and Roses' series continues to capture imaginations.

> ON AIR — Are you a fan of the ACOTAR series, or perhaps another fantasy book world? What makes these stories so captivating for you?

BOOKS · COMING UP

2 **A familiar face is returning to the cobbles as a 'Coronation Street' star makes a comeback after an 11-year absence.**

The Welsh actor is reprising his role as Owen Armstrong and has hinted at a 'cracking' storyline for his return. Fans will be keen to see what brings him back to Weatherfield.

> ON AIR — Who is your favourite 'Coronation Street' character from years gone by that you'd love to see make a return?

TV · COMING UP

3 **Milton Keynes is making a strong case to be named the UK City of Culture, with a growing buzz around its bid.**

The post-war city has made it onto the shortlist and is hoping to showcase its unique cultural offerings. Supporters believe it has a strong chance of winning the prestigious title.

> ON AIR — If you could choose any place in the UK to be the next City of Culture, where would it be and why?

CULTURE · COMING UP

4 **The shortlist for this year's prestigious Mercury Prize has been announced, celebrating the best albums from the past year.**

Several artists are returning nominees, hoping to scoop the coveted award for their latest musical offerings. Music fans will be debating who deserves to win.

> ON AIR — Which album from the past year do you think deserves to win the Mercury Prize, and why?

MUSIC · COMING UP

5 **Fans are praising the 'perfect' ending as the hugely popular anime series 'Bleach' officially concludes after 22 years.**

One of the biggest anime shows of all time has finally come to an end, much to the appreciation of its dedicated fanbase. It's been a long journey for viewers and characters alike.

> ON AIR — Are you a fan of anime, or perhaps another long-running TV series? What makes a 'perfect' ending for you?

TV · COMING UP

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Harry Kane was prematurely announced as the Ballon d'Or winner in a surprising gaffe by the organisers.**

An article claiming Kane had won the prestigious award was briefly published online on Monday, sparking confusion. It seems the England captain's dream of winning the Ballon d'Or almost came true ahead of time.

> ON AIR — If you could pick one British footballer, past or present, who you think truly deserved to win the Ballon d'Or, who would it be?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **An Under-15 World Cup match between England and the Republic of Ireland was abandoned over alleged racism.**

England's team alleged that an opposition player made a racist comment during the Group C fixture. The incident led to the game being called off, with investigations now underway.

> ON AIR — It's a reminder that even in youth sport, these issues sadly still arise. How important is it that we continue to tackle racism at all levels of the game?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Angry tennis players are urging the ATP to rethink 'drastic' cuts to doubles, warning it could destroy careers.**

Over 150 doubles players, including Wimbledon champions, have signed a letter to the ATP. They believe the proposed changes could effectively kill off the doubles format in professional tennis.

> ON AIR — Do you enjoy watching doubles tennis, or do you tend to stick to the singles matches? What's your view on changes to the sport?

TENNIS · UK

4 **Kylian Mbappé scored a late winner to earn Real Madrid a dramatic victory over Barcelona in El Clásico.**

Mbappé netted twice as Real Madrid beat their fierce rivals 2-1 at the Camp Nou in the first El Clásico of the season. It was a thrilling encounter that will delight Real fans.

> ON AIR — El Clásico always delivers drama! What's the most memorable football rivalry or fixture you've ever watched?

FOOTBALL · EUROPEAN

5 **Newcastle's Ollie Leatherbarrow has received his first call-up to the Scotland squad for the upcoming Nations Championship.**

The uncapped back-row player will join the squad for fixtures against New Zealand, Australia, and Japan. It's a big opportunity for Leatherbarrow to make his mark on the international stage.

> ON AIR — What a moment for Ollie Leatherbarrow! What's the biggest sporting achievement you've ever witnessed from someone making their debut?

RUGBY · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **The surprising joy of discovering a perfectly matched pair of socks in the laundry basket is being celebrated.**
A recent informal poll suggests that this small domestic triumph brings a disproportionate amount of satisfaction, with many describing it as a mini-victory in the daily routine.

2 **Urban gardeners are finding a new appreciation for the simple beauty of 'moss art' on garden walls and fences.**
Instead of removing it, some are actively cultivating artistic patterns with moss, turning ordinary surfaces into living, green canvases.

3 **The comforting clink of ceramic mugs in a cupboard is emerging as a sound that instantly evokes feelings of homeliness.**
Listeners to a popular podcast recently shared how this particular sound makes them feel settled and ready for a relaxing cuppa.

4 **There's a growing trend for 'micro-adventures' involving local exploration of footpaths and forgotten lanes.**
People are rediscovering the hidden charms of their immediate surroundings, often finding historical markers or unusual flora and fauna they'd previously overlooked.

5 **The satisfying 'scrunch' of rustling autumn leaves underfoot is being hailed as a simple pleasure of the season.**
Psychologists suggest that engaging multiple senses in nature, like the sound of leaves, can have a calming effect on our minds.

6 **A study reveals that people are finding unexpected comfort in the rhythmic sound of a distant, ticking clock.**
Researchers propose that the consistent, gentle ticking provides a subtle background anchor, fostering a sense of order and peace in a busy world.

7 **The gentle hum of household appliances, like a washing machine or dishwasher, is proving to be a surprising source of background comfort.**
Many respondents to a lifestyle survey mentioned these sounds as creating a 'busy but content' atmosphere in their homes.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new kind of fruit will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A GENTLE 'SQUEEZE TEST' TO CHECK FOR RIPENESS, EVEN IF WE'RE NOT ENTIRELY SURE WHAT WE'RE LOOKING FOR!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of chocolate, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: BREAKING OFF A TINY, PERFECTLY SQUARE PIECE 'JUST FOR TASTING' BEFORE COMMITTING TO A LARGER BITE!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have that 'one particular household chore' that we surprisingly enjoy, don't we?**
  Perhaps it's polishing the silver, or folding laundry, or even just washing up while listening to the radio. What's your secret favourite chore and why do you enjoy it so much?

- **You know how sometimes a specific 'everyday object' just makes you smile when you see it?**
  It could be a colourful teapot, a quirky garden gnome, or even just a particularly well-organised spice rack. What's the everyday object that brings a little cheer to your day?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that the common garden snail has around 14,000 teeth, located on a ribbon-like structure called a radula?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The sound of a bumblebee buzzing is actually its wings beating at such a rapid speed that it creates a tiny sonic boom.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of ferrets is known as a 'business'.
- The world's smallest commercially produced car was the Peel P50, a three-wheeled microcar made in the Isle of Man.
- The 'Queen's official birthday' is celebrated in June, even though her actual birthday was in April.
- Bananaphobia is the fear of bananas.
- The word 'robot' comes from the Czech word 'robota', meaning 'forced labour'.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.
- The Union Jack flag is made up of the crosses of St George, St Andrew, and St Patrick.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES TUE 27 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 300 of the year, 65 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abbán; Christian feast day: Abraham the Poor; Christian feast day: Gaudiosus of Naples; Christian feast day: Kaleb of Axum. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1938 — Lara Parker, American actress and author (died 2023)
- 1993 — Troy Gentile, American actor
- 1939 — Dallas Frazier, American country music singer-songwriter (died 2022)
- 1951 — Jayne Kennedy, American model, actress, and sportscaster
- 1942 — Lee Greenwood, American singer-songwriter
- 1992 — Emily Hagins, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1958 — David Hazeltine, American pianist and composer
- 1958 — Simon Le Bon, English singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1954 — Benjamin O. Davis, Jr. becomes the first African-American general in the United States Air Force.
- 1994 — Gliese 229B is the first Substellar Mass Object to be unquestionably identified.
- 1993 — Widerøe Flight 744 crashes in Overhalla Municipality, Norway, killing six people.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1992 — United States Navy radioman Allen R. Schindler, Jr. is murdered by shipmate Terry M. Helvey for being gay, precipitating debate about gays in the military that results in the United States' "Don't ask, don't tell" military policy.
- 1979 — Saint Vincent and the Grenadines gains its independence from the United Kingdom.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1930 — Ratifications are exchanged in London for the first London Naval Treaty go into effect immediately, further limiting the expensive naval arms race among its five signatories.
- 1964 — Ronald Reagan delivers a speech on behalf of the Republican candidate for president, Barry Goldwater. The speech launches his political career and comes to be known as "A Time for Choosing".

- 2014 — Britain withdraws from Afghanistan at the end of Operation Herrick, after 12 years four months and seven days.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES WED 28 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 301 of the year, 64 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abdias of Babylon; Christian feast day: Abgar V of Edessa (Eastern Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Eadsige; Christian feast day: Faro. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1967 — Kevin Macdonald, Scottish director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1938 — Anne Perry, English author (died 2023)
- 1983 — Joe Thomas, English actor and screenwriter
- 1978 — Gwendoline Christie, English actress
- 1978 — Justin Guarini, American singer-songwriter and actor
- 1987 — Frank Ocean, American singer-songwriter
- 1966 — Chris Bauer, American actor
- 2001 — Sonay Kartal, British tennis player

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2009 — US President Barack Obama signs the Matthew Shepard and James Byrd Jr. Hate Crimes Prevention Act.
- 1995 — The Baku Metro fire sees 289 people killed and 270 injured.
- 1989 — Aloha Island Air Flight 1712, a Twin Otter 300, crashed into terrain at night in Hawaii killing all 20 occupants onboard.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2018 — Jair Bolsonaro is elected president of Brazil with 57 million votes, with Workers' Party candidate Fernando Haddad as the runner-up. It is the first time in 16 years that a Workers' Party candidate is not elected president.
- 1956 — Hungarian Revolution: A de facto ceasefire comes into effect between armed revolutionaries and Soviet troops, who begin to withdraw from Budapest. Communist officials and facilities come under attack by revolutionaries.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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